

## ACTIVITY PACK

# Activity 4: Readme

Activity 4 - Install Tools and Skills to Do Better

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| Course      | AI Security for Autonomous AI Agents |
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Tertiary Infotech Pte Ltd | UEN 20120096W

## Readme

# Activity 4 - Install Tools and Skills to Do Better

**Purpose:** Add a ready-made **skill** to the AI agent, then re-run the Excel and PowerPoint tasks to see how much a skill improves the result.

## What you need

- The **Hermes** agent (trainer will share the link/login)
- Hermes documentation for adding tools/skills: [hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/docs](https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/docs)
- The results you saved from **Activity 2** (Excel) and **Activity 3** (PowerPoint)
- The guide in this folder: WHAT-TO-INSTALL.md

**Evidence status: SIM - all data is fictional.** Continue using the same fictional Sunset Bay Resort data.

## What is a "skill" (in plain terms)?

A **skill** is a small ready-made ability you switch on for the agent - like adding an app to a phone. You do **not** write code. You open the agent's settings, find the skill, and turn it on. After that, the agent handles that kind of task better.

## Steps

1. Open the **Hermes** agent and find where skills/tools are managed (see [hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/docs](https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/docs) - look for "Tools" or "Skills").
2. Turn on the "**spreadsheet-analyst**" skill described in WHAT-TO-INSTALL.md.
3. **Re-run your Activity 2 task** (top channels by ROI, or the exec summary) using the same GOOD prompt. Compare the new answer with your earlier one.
4. Turn on the "**slide-formatter**" skill described in WHAT-TO-INSTALL.md.
5. **Re-run your Activity 3 task** (the 5-slide deck) using the same detailed prompt. Compare the new deck with your earlier one.
6. Note, for each skill, **one clear improvement** and **one thing that stayed the same or got worse**.

## What you produce

- A before/after comparison for the Excel task (without vs with the skill)
- A before/after comparison for the PowerPoint task (without vs with the skill)
- A short verdict: was each skill worth turning on? Why?

## Reflect (Data Privacy / Job Impact / Ethical Concerns / Cyber Security)

- **Data Privacy:** A new skill may read your uploaded file. Do you know what it can access before you switch it on?
- **Job Impact:** With skills doing more, which parts of the job become "checking the agent" rather than "doing the work"?
- **Ethical Concerns:** A skill that formats nicely can also make a wrong answer look convincing. How do you still verify?
- **Cyber Security:** Who in a real workplace should approve a new skill before staff install it?

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